

Description of the Owens Property

Ownership

? Owens

Four Mile Village

Boxford, MA 01921

Location

Off Lockwood Lane

Boxford, MA

Essex County

Description

This property is approximately 45 acres of fields, wetlands and woodland. Topography is gently rolling. Upland soils are typically well drained, rocky and acidic. Most of the wetlands are associated with the floodplain of Fish Brook which bisects the property lengthwise.

The area to the south of Fish Brook is primarily covered by oak/pine woodland. This forest has not been logged or selectively cut thus many of the trees are mature and likely greater than 80 years old. White pine seedlings and saplings are common. White pine also forms stands along the edge of the floodplain. Hickories and red maple are common throughout. Much of the area to the north of Fish Brook is rolling fields. These fields are dominated by native grasses such as little bluestem and have both mature and seedling red cedars scattered throughout. The edges of these fields resemble "old field" habitat where trees and shrubs have been allowed to grow. Two streams meander through these fields which are lined with alder and dogwood thickets. A small pond is also located between the fields and Lockwood Lane. Much of Fish Brook is lined with wetland shrubs and herbaceous plants. Several marsh/wet meadow communities exist along the brook where topography is level.

The abundance of edge and the diversity of habitats supports an abundance of wildlife. An active fox den is located in the fields along the brook. Rodents, white-tailed deer, songbirds and game birds frequent the fields and brook edge. Other species likely using the property include otter, turkey, woodcock, grassland songbirds, marsh birds, fish and other wildlife associated with riparian habitat. The property is just down stream from rare wetlands wildlife estimated habitat. The property includes approximately 2000+ feet of both sides of Fish Brook.

This property has connecting trails with the trails on the Lockwood lands and the Boxford State Forest. These trails meander through the fields and along Fish Brook. A bridge located at an historical crossing allows horseback riders and other recreationalists to cross the brook.